Leucoderma is a non – communicable diseases caused by partial or total loss of pigmentation in the skin **(melanin pigment).** This condition affects people of any age, gender and ethnicity. There is no cure. It does not spread by touching, sharing food or sitting together.

6.4 Specific health problems of children

Anaemia

It is caused by eating food with less iron content and can also be caused due to feeding some other foods instead of breast milk. Severe anaemia in children may lead to hookworm infection, chronic diarrhoea and dysentery. In the recent days, school going children, especially girls are affected by anaemia. The Government of Tamil Nadu provides iron folic tablets to all the girls in the schools of all areas every week.

The signs of anaemia

- Pale or transparent skin, the inner surface of eye lids are pale, white fingernails, pale gums, weakness and fatigue.
- In severe cases, face and feet may be swollen, the heart beat is rapid and with shortness of breath.
- Children and women who eat mud are usually anaemic.

Treatment and prevention of anaemia

Anaemia can be preventing by takes proper food and diet.

As a general rule, iron supplements should be given orally, not to be injected, because it is dangerous.

Food

Moringa leaves, dates, liver (sheep and chicken), green, green leafy vegetables like beans, peas, lentils and greed banana.

Pills

Cod liver oil tablet, Ferrous sulphate.

6.5 Safety and First Aid

First aid is the immediate treatment given to the victim of trauma or sudden illness before medical help is made available. First aid is important for following reasons.

- It saves the life.
- It prevents further bleeding and determine the condition of the patient.
- It relieves the pain.
- It provides a medical care available at the earliest.

6.5.1 Burns

The tissue damage caused by heat, chemical, electricity, sunlight or nuclear radiation is known as burns. Mostly burns are caused by scalds, building fires, flammable liquid and gases. There are three types of burns, according to degree of burning.

- First-degree burns affect only the outer layer (called the epidermis) of the skin.

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